Rapturous Risotto

Idealized Post 13 recipe. Cèpes build the base, meadow mushrooms cook in the risotto, and brown Paris mushrooms are browned separately for contrast.

Ingredients

- Baldo risotto rice
- Dried cèpes / porcini - about 5% of the dry rice-and-cèpes base
- Rosés des prés / meadow mushrooms
- Brown champignons de Paris
- Onion
- Garlic
- Olive oil
- Japanese soy sauce
- Fresh thyme
- Chives
- Butter
- Parmesan
- Salt
- Hot water or light stock

Method

1. Prepare the cèpes. Clean the dried mushrooms lightly in water, then sponge them. Wet and rehydrate them with hot water infused with thyme. Reserve the mushroom liquid for the risotto.

2. Prepare the fresh mushrooms. Cut the meadow mushrooms for the risotto itself. Keep the brown Paris mushrooms separate and cut them for pan-browning, so the two fresh mushroom treatments remain distinct.

3. Brown the Paris mushrooms. Heat a wide pan with olive oil and cook the brown Paris mushrooms hard enough to develop real colour. Do not crowd or stew them. Near the end, add garlic, then finish with a restrained amount of Japanese soy sauce and chives. Reserve.

4. Start the risotto. Soften the onion in olive oil and butter. Add the Baldo rice and toast it briefly. Add the cèpes and the meadow mushrooms.

5. Cook gradually. Add the hot thyme-and-cèpe infusion, supplemented with hot water or light stock as needed, a little at a time. Cook until the rice is tender but still structured and the mixture is creamy rather than wet.

6. Finish. Off the heat, work in butter and Parmesan. Taste before adding salt: the cheese and soy sauce already contribute seasoning.

7. Serve. Plate the risotto and finish with the separately browned Paris mushrooms. Add chives and serve immediately.